

General Education Reflection

During my time at Iowa State University, I have gained vast knowledge from many sources. Typically, as a Computer Engineer, this knowledge is often in the form of logic, numbers, and math. However, I have also been able to expand my knowledge in other fields that were unexpected to me. These were from my general education classes. Specifically, the ones I want to focus on are US 3750 - Russia Today and MUSIC 102 - Introduction to Music Listening.

First RUS 3750, I learned about Russian history, culture, politics, and how the country's past continues to shape its decisions today. We discussed global issues, international relations, and how different societies perceive conflict, innovation, and progress. What stuck with me was the fall of the Soviet Union and its impact on the everyday lives of the people. They went from knowing exactly how their life would be in a very stable system to having a huge change, and they had to think from a whole different perspective. I try to apply what the people of the Soviet Union went through in my own life. Sometimes, things don't go as planned, and it is essential to be able to adapt and find new solutions.

MUSIC 102 might not seem related to engineering in any way, but there is a reason why a large majority of engineers find music so interesting. Below every creative action, there is an underlying subconscious reason why those thoughts are made. Like the resonance of the notes or the pitch of a chord. When you get down to it, music is all math at its fundamental level, and that shows when you look across many different cultures that had no interaction with each other. This can all be tied in with engineering this specifically showing how two different people can find the same thing through math.

Both of these courses helped me grow in different ways, but together they added a depth to my education that I wouldn't have gotten from just taking technical classes. They taught me to approach problems from multiple angles, consider the cultural and human impact of technology, and remain open to new ideas. Even though they were outside my major, these general education classes ultimately shaped how I approach engineering today and how I'll continue to solve problems in the future.